

Delphine Norwood

Chronicle, volume 1

Restless and curious bookbinder of Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity

Volume 3 of 3 in the Delphine Norwood collection. The other volumes cover the rest of this character's record.

About this volume

Day-to-day records kept by Delphine, bookbinder of Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity, in no particular order of importance. Among the things Delphine keeps at the Undermarket is a coil of rope; Delphine calls it 'The Apology' and will not explain why. It appears in these pages more often than it deserves.

<i>Full name</i>	Delphine Norwood
<i>Volume</i>	Chronicle 1
<i>Name of the coil of rope</i>	The Apology

Entries

Entry 1, winter of year 39

The weather turned. Delphine moved the tin whistle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. Delphine won 53 meridian scrip on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper. Baptiste came by asking about the quarantine. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the census. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Delphine polished 'The Apology', the coil of rope, and said nothing about it.

Entry 2, summer of year 39

Delphine spent the day counting stock at the Glass District: 67 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Delphine closed early, walked to the flooded lower rings, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 3, spring of year 39

At Sector 9 transit hub, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the census reached Sector 9 transit hub. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Delphine closed early, walked to the Glass District, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 4, spring of year 39

Delphine found a hand bell half-buried near the flooded lower rings and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the harvest count reached the flooded lower rings. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Delphine found a clockwork bird half-buried near the flooded lower rings and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Delphine spent the day counting stock at the flooded lower rings: 23 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short.

Entry 5, winter of year 39

Rumours about the comet reached the Undermarket. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the Undermarket. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the comet reached the Undermarket. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Delphine found a bolt of linen half-buried near the Undermarket and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 6, spring of year 39

At Kowloon Arcade, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Delphine spent the day counting stock at Kowloon Arcade: 18 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. The weather turned. Delphine moved the brass lantern indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the quarantine.

Entry 7, winter of year 39

A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the new curfew reached the Undermarket. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the Undermarket; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 8, spring of year 39

Emeric came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. Delphine closed early, walked to Sector 9 transit hub, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the comet flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 9, summer of year 40

Delphine closed early, walked to the flooded lower rings, and watched the lights come on. At Kowloon Arcade, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Delphine found a oilskin map half-buried near Kowloon Arcade and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Delphine was hired to carry a cracked compass from Kowloon Arcade to the flooded lower rings without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 10, autumn of year 40

Delphine found a tin whistle half-buried near the Undermarket and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Delphine moved the tin whistle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the old tunnels. The weather turned. Delphine moved the sextant indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the harvest count. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Delphine has a suspect and is probably right. Delphine closed early, walked to Sector 9 transit hub, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 11, winter of year 40

Phaedra came by asking about the quarantine. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Delphine spent the day counting stock at Sector 9 transit hub: 20 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short. The weather turned. Delphine moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet.

Entry 12, autumn of year 40

Delphine spent the day counting stock at Kowloon Arcade: 40 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short. Zubair came by asking about the old tunnels. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Delphine repaired the signal flag at Kowloon Arcade for Kwame, who paid in 20 meridian scrip and a long story about the tax on doors.

Entry 13, spring of year 41

A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside Sector 9 transit hub; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Delphine repaired the bolt of linen at Sector 9 transit hub for Matthias, who paid in 8 meridian scrip and a long story about the harvest count. Delphine closed early, walked to the flooded lower rings, and watched the lights come on. Delphine closed early, walked to the flooded lower rings, and watched the lights come on. Delphine won 30 meridian scrip on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 14, summer of year 41

Delphine closed early, walked to the Glass District, and watched the lights come on. Rumours about the harvest count reached the Undermarket. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Delphine has a suspect and is probably right. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 15, summer of year 41

Delphine spent the day counting stock at Kowloon Arcade: 74 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Noor came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. Delphine repaired the signal flag at Kowloon Arcade for Orsolya, who paid in 74 meridian scrip and a long story about the right way to mend a net. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 16, autumn of year 41

The weather turned. Delphine moved the grain scale indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Delphine has a suspect and is probably right. Delphine spent the day counting stock at the flooded lower rings: 42 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short.

Entry 17, autumn of year 42

A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Halcyon came by asking about the new curfew. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. At the flooded lower rings, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Delphine found a ledger half-buried near the flooded lower rings and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 18, autumn of year 42

Delphine closed early, walked to Kowloon Arcade, and watched the lights come on. Rumours about the quarantine reached the Undermarket. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the Undermarket; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 19, autumn of year 42

Delphine closed early, walked to the Glass District, and watched the lights come on. Nadira came by asking about the census. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. Delphine won 27 meridian scrip on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on supper. The weather turned. Delphine moved the copper pipe indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tariff on salt.

Entry 20, spring of year 42

the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the comet. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Delphine was hired to carry a ledger from Sector 9 transit hub to the Glass District without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 21, spring of year 42

A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the Undermarket; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Juniper came by asking about who really won the regatta. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. Delphine closed early, walked to the Glass District, and watched the lights come on. Nkechi came by asking about the comet. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 22, summer of year 42

Delphine spent the day counting stock at the flooded lower rings: 90 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. At the flooded lower rings, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone. Delphine closed early, walked to the Glass District, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 23, autumn of year 42

Delphine spent the day counting stock at the flooded lower rings: 66 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Delphine repaired the signal flag at the flooded lower rings for Kwame, who paid in 21 meridian scrip and a long story about the comet. Rumours about the new curfew reached the flooded lower rings. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Delphine spent the day counting stock at the flooded lower rings: 66 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short.

Entry 24, winter of year 42

Delphine spent the day counting stock at the flooded lower rings: 21 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short. A dispute over the census flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Kestrel came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 25, winter of year 42

Delphine won 19 meridian scrip on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on supper. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached Sector 9 transit hub. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Delphine moved the cracked compass indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about who really won the regatta. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the missing shipment reached Sector 9 transit hub. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 26, autumn of year 42

A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk came by asking about the tariff on salt. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. Delphine found a ledger half-buried near the flooded lower rings and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Delphine repaired the coil of rope at the flooded lower rings for Percival, who paid in 21 meridian scrip and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. A dispute over the census flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 27, spring of year 42

Delphine closed early, walked to the Undermarket, and watched the lights come on. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Delphine closed early, walked to the Undermarket, and watched the lights come on. Delphine won 20 meridian scrip on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper. The weather

turned. Delphine moved the wax seal indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the missing shipment.

Entry 28, summer of year 42

The weather turned. Delphine moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the old tunnels. Rumours about the tax on doors reached the Undermarket. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Quillon came by asking about the singing at the docks. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 29, winter of year 42

The weather turned. Delphine moved the brass lantern indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the quarantine. The weather turned. Delphine moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Delphine repaired the spool of wire at the flooded lower rings for Zubair, who paid in 11 meridian scrip and a long story about the missing shipment. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 30, winter of year 42

Delphine was hired to carry a oilskin map from the flooded lower rings to Sector 9 transit hub without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Delphine was hired to carry a brass lantern from the flooded lower rings to Sector 9 transit hub without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the flooded lower rings, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 31, spring of year 42

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Delphine has a suspect and is probably right. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the Glass District; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 32, autumn of year 42

the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the flooded lower rings. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the old tunnels. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Delphine has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 33, winter of year 43

Xavier came by asking about the comet. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. Delphine found a coil of rope half-buried near the flooded lower rings and spent the evening trying to work out

who had lost it. Nkechi came by asking about the new curfew. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. Sunniva came by asking about the harvest count. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. Marisol came by asking about the old tunnels. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 34, autumn of year 43

Delphine won 81 meridian scrip on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on supper. The weather turned. Delphine moved the iron kettle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the right way to mend a net. Delphine won 54 meridian scrip on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 35, autumn of year 43

Delphine was hired to carry a oilskin map from Sector 9 transit hub to the Undermarket without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Delphine has a suspect and is probably right. Delphine spent the day counting stock at Sector 9 transit hub: 26 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short.

Entry 36, winter of year 43

Delphine spent the day counting stock at the Glass District: 31 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Delphine repaired the sack of salt at the Glass District for Ignatius, who paid in 82 meridian scrip and a long story about the price of lamp oil. Someone left a coil of rope on the doorstep with no note. Delphine has a suspect and is probably right. Delphine closed early, walked to the Undermarket, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the Glass District; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 37, summer of year 43

Delphine repaired the signal flag at the Glass District for Seraphine, who paid in 64 meridian scrip and a long story about the missing shipment. Delphine won 37 meridian scrip on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the Glass District; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zora came by asking about the new curfew. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead.